

Môn thi: **TIẾNG ANH**

Thời gian: **180** phút (không kể thời gian giao đề)

Số phách

Đề thi gồm có **14** trang

- Thí sinh **KHÔNG** được sử dụng tài liệu, kể cả từ điển.
- Giám thị **KHÔNG** giải thích gì thêm.

I. LISTENING (5.0 points)

- The listening section is in **FOUR** parts. You will hear each part **TWICE**. At the beginning of each part, you will hear a sound.
- There will be a piece of music at the beginning and at the end of the listening section. You will have **TWO** minutes to check your answers at the end of the listening section.
- All the other instructions are included in the recording.

Part 1. For questions 1-5, listen to a news report on the smart city and decide whether each of the following statements is True (T), False (F) or Not Given (NG) according to what you hear. Write T, F or NG in the corresponding numbered boxes provided.

1. Singapore started its Smart Nation program in 2014 to improve waste collection systems in the city.
2. In Dubai, citizens can renew their vehicle registration, pay their electricity bills, or track their deliveries by using a privately-funded app.
3. The sensors in Barcelona's parking system can detect whether a car is in a spot by using light and metal detectors.
4. Smart street lights in Barcelona are always bright at maximum level, regardless of activity.
5. Juniper Research predicts that the cost savings from smart cities will continue to increase steadily after 2021.

Your answers:

1.	2.	3.	4.	5.
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Part 2. For questions 6-10, listen to a talk about the history of the industrial revolution and answer the questions. Write NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS taken from the recording for each answer in the corresponding numbered boxes provided.

6. Prior to the industrial revolution, what were the economies in Europe and America?
7. Besides factories and ships, what ran on the steam engine?
8. What was the development seen in the textile industry?
9. What title did Great Britain hold for such a long time?
10. By whom were engineers and inventors supported in British society?

Your answers:

6.	7.	8.
9.	10.	

Part 3. You will hear an interview in which two filmmakers, Tilly Woodford and Lee Davies, are talking about a documentary they have made about animals. For questions 11-15, select the best answer A, B, C or D.

11. Tilly says the initial inspiration for the documentary came from:

- A. experiencing an intense emotional bond with an animal.
- B. wanting to encourage her own children to appreciate animals.
- C. realising her understanding of animals was quite limited.
- D. thinking about her childhood memories of keeping animals.

12. How did Lee originally feel about working on the documentary?

- A. Curious about whether he would work well with Tilly
- B. Guilty about having to abandon his other project
- C. Anxious about working in a different way
- D. Doubtful about the level of interest in the subject

13. What does Tilly suggest about the man she interviewed?
- A. He found it hard to take care of his pets.
 - B. He didn't take his pets' needs into consideration.
 - C. He disagreed with Tilly's suggestions about pet nutrition.
 - D. He only focused on the fun sides of pet ownership.
14. What discovery surprised Lee and Tilly most during their research?
- A. How far some people go to protect wild animals
 - B. How little is known about animal communication
 - C. How much society's attitudes to pets have changed
 - D. How important the pet sector is to the economy
15. When reflecting on the documentary, they express regrets that:
- A. they had to cut several stories from the final version.
 - B. the documentary contained few of their own insights.
 - C. they focused on the least controversial issues.
 - D. their small budget limited what they could do

11.	12.	13.	14.	15.
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Part 4. For questions 16-25, Listen to this extract and fill in the missing information. Write NO MORE THAN THREE words for each answer. Write your answers in the corresponding numbered boxes provided.

In 1972, ethologist John B. Calhoun created *Universe 25*, a controlled habitat for mice with abundant food, water, nesting space, and no predators. Eight healthy mice were chosen from **16** _____ of the National Institutes of Health to begin the experiment, and the population initially grew rapidly, doubling every 55 days.

By day 315, the population of Universe 25 exceeded six hundred, with mice crowding together as they moved through the stairwells to access food, water, and rest. At this point, **17** _____. As competition for space and roles increased, males abandoned attempts to defend territory, **18** _____ occurred in the colony, and females withdrew into isolation. Notably, some males, termed "the beautiful ones," avoided both sex and aggression, living only to eat and groom, covering themselves in **19** _____. Violence, neglect of young, and even cannibalism spread, signaling the breakdown of social bonds.

The population peaked at 2,200 on day 560, but reproduction soon collapsed. The mice were no longer able to repopulate; even those still capable of reproduction, like the "beautiful ones" and the **20** _____ females, had lost the social functioning needed to mate and raise young. By day 920, the last conception occurred, and in 1973 the final mouse died. Calhoun described two deaths: first the collapse of spirit and society, then physical extinction.

It was not Calhoun's first time to create such a **21** _____. Since the 1940s, he had designed "utopian" settings for rats and mice, and the outcomes were strikingly consistent: overcrowding first triggered aggression and **22** _____, then gave way to withdrawal, self-destructive behavior, and eventual extinction.

Calhoun noted in a famous paper that: Regardless of how advanced a society may be, when the pool of individuals who could occupy **23** _____ far surpasses the available positions, the inevitable outcome is conflict and disorder.

He concluded that overpopulation creates a "behavioral sink", the drive to gather in crowds despite destructive consequences. While some saw this as a warning about human overpopulation, Calhoun contended that humans could expand **24** _____ through ideas and technology, offering hope for coping with crowding. In the later stages of his work, he shifted focus to potential

remedies, designing innovative environments aimed at reducing 25 _____ of overcrowding.

Your answers:

16.	17.
18.	19.
20.	21.
22.	23.
24.	25.

II. READING (8.0 points)

II.1. LANGUAGE IN USE

Part 1: For questions 26-35, read the passage below and decide which answer (A,B,C,D) best fits each space. Write the letter A, B, C or D in the numbered boxes provided.

Astronomers these days can do the most amazing things. If someone (26) _____ a match on the moon, they could spot the flare. From the tinniest throbs and wobbles of distant stars they can (27) _____ the size and character and even potential habitability of planets much too remote to be seen – planets so distant that it would take us half a million years in a spaceship to get there. With their radio (28) _____, they can capture (29) _____ of radiation so preposterously faint that the total amount of energy collected from outside the solar system by all of them together since collecting began (in 1951) is “less than the energy of a single snowflake striking the ground,” in the (30) _____ of Carl Sagan. (31) _____ short, there isn’t a great deal that goes on in the universe that astronomers can’t find when they have a(n) (32) _____ to. Which is why it

is all the more remarkable to (33) _____ that until 1978 no one had ever noticed that Pluto has a moon. In the summer of that year, a young astronomer named James Christy at the U.S Naval Observatory in Flagstaff, Arizona, was making a routine(34) _____ of photographic images of Pluto when he saw that there was something there – something (35) _____ and uncertain but definitely other than Pluto. Consulting colleague named Robert Harrington, he concluded that what

he was looking at was a moon. And it wasn’t just a moon. Relative to the planet, it was the biggest moon in the solar system.

(Adapted from A Short History of Nearly Everything by Bill Bryson)

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|-------------------|----------------|------------------|----------------|
| 26. A. blazed | B. hit | C. beat | D. struck |
| 27. A. defer | B. refer | C. infer | D. prefer |
| 28. A. telescopes | B. microscopes | C. kaleidoscopes | D. endoscopes |
| 29. A. wisps | B. wasps | C. wads | D. wimps |
| 30. A. citation | B. quote | C. words | D. maxims |
| 31. A. On | B. In | C. By | D. At |
| 32. A. head | B. care | C. notion | D. mind |
| 33. A. refract | B. reflect | C. deflect | D. detract |
| 34. A. inspection | B. autopsy | C. quest | D. examination |
| 35. A. blurry | B. blotched | C. bleak | D. bloated |

Your answers:

26.	27.	28.	29.	30.
31.	32.	33.	34.	35.

Part 2. For questions 36-40, write the correct form of each bracketed word in the numbered space provided in the column on the right to complete the sentence. There are FIVE words that you do not need to use.

<i>incredible</i>	<i>settle</i>	<i>significant</i>	<i>pay</i>	<i>acquire</i>
<i>extort</i>	<i>grunt</i>	<i>addict</i>	<i>deteriorate</i>	<i>astound</i>

The weird world of leveraged buyouts

Want to buy a multinational corporation but have insufficient funds to do it? No problem? Just use a leveraged buyout (LBO).

In an LBO, the buyer uses a relatively small sum of money, typically 10% of the total price, to purchase a publicly traded company. The remaining 90% necessary for the (36)comes from a bank, with the acquired business itself serving as collateral to guarantee that the loan will be (37).....

Ironically, LBOs often target strong, successful businesses, which provide the greatest security for lenders. It's no wonder, then, that the threat of an LBO is so (38)..... for business leaders who wish to retain control of the companies they run.

In case you're now contemplating your own LBO, be warned that it's not quite as effortless as it sounds. Above all, you'll need to persuade a bank to lend you the money, usually at an absolutely (39)..... interest rate. Plus, even if your plan comes off, you'll have to deal with the wrath of (40)managers and employees.

Your answers

36.	37.	38.	39.	40.
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Part 3. The passage below contains 5 grammatical mistakes. For questions 41-45, UNDERLINE the mistakes and WRITE YOUR CORRECTIONS in the numbered space provided in the column on the right.

Scientists for the first time have used gene editing techniques to make pigs resistant to one of the world's costly livestock diseases, says The Times. Bred at the University of Edinburgh's Roslin Institute, the animals had a short section of their DNA excised to stop them being infected from PRRS, a deadly virus which costs the industry about £1.75bn a year in Europe and the US alone.

The virus enters pig cells through a surface protein called CD163; by "editing" the genetic instructions for making the protein, the scientists were able to shut the virus off – with no sign of harm to the animals. However, it remains unclear when, if never, farmers will be able to make use of the technology. Scientists need first to make sure that there are no long-term effects on the animals, and then to open a public debate about the acceptability of meat from gene-edited animals going on the market. The researchers expect some public resistance, but stress that it is very different from genetic modification, which introduces DNA from other species. "This animal is not what we call 'transgenic'," said Dr Christine Tait-Burkard, the study's lead author. "It's 100% pig DNA in there still."

(Adapted from The Week)

Your answers

41.	42.	43.	44.	45.
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II. 2. READING (5.0 points)

Part 1. For questions 46-55, read the passage and fill in each of the following numbered blanks with ONE suitable word. Write your answers in the corresponding numbered boxes provided.

The first post-lockdown crops of the land army have been harvested. The food – chard, spinach, lettuce and radish – is being parceled out to the local shops, market stalls and those in (46) _____. Now the volunteer labor force has its sights on a new goal: a land-use revolution that will (47) _____ UK farming more nature friendly, plant-based and resilient to (48) _____ shocks.

At Machynlleth, a bucolic town on the southern fringe of Snowdonia, the recently formed Planna Fwyd! (Plant Food!) movement is encouraging sheep farmers to diversify (49) _____ vegetable production as their ancestors did. Teams of volunteers have sown (50) _____ of potatoes and, once or twice a week, they now fan across the slopes to tend gooseberry bushes, peas and squash. Others distribute seed

packets to (51) _____ families and run online classes on how to grow plants at home.

“If the whole coronavirus experience has taught us anything, it is (52) _____ we should be more self-sufficient. It was terrifying seeing the (53) _____ shop shelves,” said Chris Higgins, a retired academic who gets as much (54) _____ as he gives from the voluntary work. “It’s very enriching. Growing and cooking food and working together is a great way of (55) _____ with the local community and nature at the same time.”

(adapted from “Britain beyond lockdown: can we make more space for nature?” by Jonathan Watts, the Guardian)

Your answers:

46.	47.	48.	49.	50.
51.	52.	53.	54.	55.

Part 2: Read the following passage and do the tasks that follow.

Volatility Kills

A . Despite gun battles in the capital of Chad, rioting in Kenya, and Galloping inflation in Zimbabwe, the economies of sub-Saharan Africa are, as a whole, in better shape than they were a few years ago. The World Bank has reported recently that this part of the continent experienced a respectable growth rate of 5.6 percent in 2006 and a higher rate from 1995 to 2005 than in previous decades. The bank has given a cautious assessment that the region may have reached a turning point. An overriding question for developmental economists remains whether the upswing will continue so Africans can grow their way out of poverty that relegates some 40 percent of the nearly 744 million in that region to living on less than a dollar a day. The optimism, when inspected more closely, maybe short-lived because of the persistence of a devastating pattern of economic volatility that has lingered for decades.

B. “In reality, African countries grow as fast as Asian countries and other developing countries during the good times, but afterward they see growth collapses,” comments Jorge Arbache, a senior World Bank economist. “How to prevent collapses may be as important as promoting growth.” If these collapses had not occurred, he observes, the level of gross domestic product for each citizen of the 48 nations of sub-Saharan Africa would have been third higher.

C. The prerequisites to prevent the next crash are not in place, according to a World Bank study issued in January, *Is Africa’s Recent Growth Robust?* The growth period that began in 1995, driven by a commodities boom spurred in particular by demand from China, may not be sustainable, because the economic fundamentals- new investment and the ability to stave off inflation, among other factors-are absent. The region lacks the necessary infrastructure that would encourage investors to look to Africa to find the next Bengaluru (Bangalore) or Shenzhen, a November report from the bank concludes. For sub-Saharan countries rich in oil and other resources, a boom period may even undermine efforts to institute sound economic practices.. From 1996 to 2005, with growth accelerating, measures of governance- factors such as political stability, rule of law, and control of corruption- actually worsened, especially for countries endowed with abundant mineral resources, the January report notes.

D. Perhaps the most incisive analysis of the volatility question comes from Paul Collier, a longtime specialist in African economics at the University of Oxford and author of the recent book *The Bottom Billion*. He advocates a range of options that the U.S. and other nations could adopt when formulating policy toward African countries. They include revamped trade measures, better-apportioned aid, and sustained military intervention in certain instances, to avert what he sees as a rapidly accelerating divergence of the world’s poorest, primarily in Africa, from the rest of the world, even other developing nations such India and China.

E. Collier finds that bad governance is the main reason countries fail to take advantage of the revenue bonanza that results from a boom. Moreover, a democratic government, he adds, often makes the aftermath of a boom worse. “Instead of democracy disciplining governments to manage these resource booms well, what happens is that the resource revenues corrupt the normal functioning of democracy- unless you stop (them from) corrupting the normal function of democracy with sufficient checks and

balances”, he said at a talk in January at the Carnegie Council in New York City.

F. Collier advocates that African nations institute an array of standards and codes to bolster governments, one of which would substitute auctions for bribes in apportioning mineral rights and another of which would tax export revenues adequately. He cites the Democratic Republic of the Congo, which took in \$ 200 million from mineral exports in 2006 yet collected only \$86000 in royalties for its treasury. “If a nation gets these points right,” he argues, “It’s going to develop. If it gets them wrong, it won’t.”

G. To encourage reform, Collier recommends that the G8 nations agree to accept these measures as voluntary guidelines for multinationals doing business in Africa- companies, for instance, would only enter new contracts through auctions monitored by an international verification group. Such an agreement would follow the examples of the so-called Kimberley Process, which has effectively undercut the trade in blood diamonds, and the Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative, in which a government must report to its citizens the revenues it receives from sales of natural resources.

H. These measures, he says, are more important than elevating aid levels, an approach emphasized by economist Jeffrey D. Sachs of Columbia University and celebrity activists such as Bono. Collier insists that first Angola receives tens of billions of dollars in oil revenue and whether it gets a few hundred million more or less in aid is really second-order.

For the question 56- 59,

Use the information in the passage to match the people (listed A-C) with opinions or deeds below.

Write Use the information in the passage to match the people (listed A-C) with opinions or deeds below.

NB you may use any letter more than once

- A. Jeffrey D. Dachs
- B. Paul Collier
- C. Jorge Arbache

- 56. An unexpectedly opposite result
- 57. Estimated more productive outcomes if it were not for sudden economic downturns
- 58.A proposal for a range of recommended instructions for certain countries to narrow the widening economic gap
- 59. An advocate for a method used for a specific assessment

Your answers:

56.	57.	58.	59.
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Questions 60-65

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage ?

- TRUE if the statement is true
- FALSE if the statement is false
- NOT GIVEN if the information is not given in the passage

- 60. The instability in an economy in some African countries might negatively impact their continuing growth after a certain level has been reached.
- 61. Collier is the most influential scholar in the study of the volatility problem.
- 62. Certain African governments levy considerable taxes on people profiting greatly from exportation.
- 63. Some African nation’s decisions on addressing specific existing problems are directly related to the future of their economic trends.
- 64. Collier regards Jeffrey D. Sachs recommended a way of evaluating of title importance.
- 65. The Kimberley Process has been effective in reducing the trade in blood diamonds.

Your answers:

60.	61.	62.	63.	64.	65.
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Questions 66-69

Complete the following summary of the paragraphs of Reading Passage Volatility Kills, using No More than Three words from the Reading Passage Volatility Kills for each answer.

According to one research carried by the world bank, some countries in Africa may suffer from (66) _____ due to the lack of according preconditions. they experienced a growth stimulated by (67) _____, but according to another study, they may not keep this trend stable because they don't have (68) _____ which would attract investors. to some countries with abundant resources, this fast-growth period might even mean something devastating to their endeavor. during one specific decade accompanied by (69) _____ as a matter of fact, the governing saw a deterioration.

66.	67.	68.	69.
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Part 3. In the passage below, six paragraphs have been removed. For questions 69-75, read the passage and choose from paragraphs A-G the one which fits each gap. There is ONE extra paragraph which you do not need to use. Write the letters A-G in the corresponding numbered boxes provided.

THE DO -GOODERS

The people who changed the morals of English society.

In the last decades of the 18th century, the losers seriously outnumbered the winners. Those who were fortunate enough to occupy the upper levels of society, celebrated their good fortune by living a hedonistic life of gambling, parties and alcohol. It was their moral right, they felt, to exploit the weak and the poor. Few of them thought their lives should change, even fewer believed it could.

70.

But the decisive turning point for moral reform was the French revolution. John Bowlder, a popular moralist of the time, blamed the destruction of French society on a moral crisis. Edmund Burke, a Whig statesman agreed. 'When your fountain is choked up and polluted,' he wrote, 'the stream will not run long or clear.' If the English society did not reform, ruin would surely follow.

71.

Englishmen were deeply afraid that the immorality of France would invade England. Taking advantage of this, Burke was able to gain considerable support by insisting that the French did not have the moral qualifications to be a civilised nation. He pronounced 'Better this island should be sunk to the bottom of the sea than... it should not be a country of religion and morals.'

72

Sobering though these messages were, the aristocracy of the time was open to such reforms, not least due to fear. France's attempt to destroy their nobility did much to encourage the upper classes to examine and re-evaluate their own behaviour. Added to this was the arrival of French noble émigrés to British shores. As these people were dependant on the charity of the British aristocracy, it became paramount to amend morals and suppress all vices in order to uphold the state.

73

Whether the vices of the rich and titled stopped or were merely cloaked is open to question. But it is clear that by the turn of the century, a more circumspect society had emerged. Styles of dress became more moderate, and the former adornments of swords, buckles and powdered hair were no longer seen. There was a profusion of moral didactic literature available. Public hangings ceased and riots became much rarer.

74

One such person was Thomas Wackley who in 1823 founded a medical journal called 'the Lancet'. At this time, Medicine was still a profession reserved for the rich, and access to knowledge was impossible for the common man. The Lancet shone a bright light on the questionable practices undertaken in medicine and particularly in surgery, and finally led to improved standards of care.

75

How though did changes at the top affect the people at the bottom of the societal hierarchy? Not all reformers concerned themselves with changes at the authoritative and governmental levels. Others concentrated on improving the lives and morals of the poor. In the midst of the industrial revolution, the poorest in society were in dire straits. Many lived in slums and sanitation was poor. No-one wanted the responsibility of improvement.

But one woman, Octavia Hill, was willing to step up to the mark. Hill, despite serious opposition by the men who still dominated English society, succeeded in opening a number of housing facilities for the poor. But, recognising the weaknesses of a charity-dependent culture, Hill enforced high moral standards, strict measures in hygiene and cleanliness upon her tenants, and, in order to promote a culture of industry, made them work for any financial handouts.

Could local authorities impose such measures today? Probably not. Even so, the legacy of the moral reform of the late 1800s and 1900s lives on today. Because of it, the British have come to expect a system which is competent, fair to all and free from corruption. Nowadays everyone has a right to a home, access to education, and protection at work and in hospital. This is all down to the men and women who did not just observe society's ills from a distance, but who dared to take steps to change it.

Missing Paragraphs:

A. But a moral makeover was on the horizon, and one of the first people to promote it was William Wilberforce, better known for his efforts in abolishing the slave trade. Writing to a friend, Lord Muncaster, he stated that 'the universal corruption and profligacy of the times...taking its rise amongst the rich and luxurious has now ... spread its destructive poison through the whole body of the people.'

B. The attitudes of the upper classes became increasingly critical during the latter part of the eighteenth century. In 1768, the Lord of the Treasury was perfectly at ease to introduce his mistress to the Queen, but a generation later, such behaviour would have been unacceptable. Such attitudes are also seen in the diaries of Samuel Pepys, who, in 1793 rambles without criticism about his peer's many mistresses. A few years later, his tone had become infinitely more critical.

C. In time, the fervour for improved morals strayed beyond personal behaviour and towards a new governance. People called for a tightening of existing laws which had formerly been enforced only laxly. Gambling, duelling, swearing, prostitution, pornography and adultery laws were more strictly upheld to the extent that several fashionable ladies were fined fifty pounds each for gambling in a private residence.

D. At first, moralists did not look for some tangible end to moral behaviour. They concerned themselves with the spiritual salvation of the rich and titled members of society, believing that the moral tone set by the higher ranks would influence the lower orders. For example, Samuel Parr, preaching at London's St Paul's Cathedral, said 'If the rich man...abandons himself to sloth and all the vices which sloth generates, he corrupts by his example. He permits...his immediate attendants to be, like him, idle and profligate.'

E. So far, however, circumspection in the upper classes had done little to improve the lives of those in the lower classes. But that was to change. Against a backdrop of the moral high ground, faults in the system started to stand out. One by one, people started to question the morality of those in authority.

F. Similar developments occurred in the Civil Service. Civil servants were generally employed as a result of nepotism or acquaintance, and more often than not took advantage of their power to provide for themselves at the expense of the public. Charles Trevelyan, an official at the London Treasury, realised the weaknesses in the system and proposed that all civil servants were employed as a result of entrance examinations, thus creating a system which was politically independent and consisted of people who were genuinely able to do the job.

G. These prophecies roused a little agitation when first published in 1790. But it was the events in 1792-93 which shocked England into action. Over in France, insurrection had led to war and massacre. The King and Queen had been tried and executed. France was now regarded as completely immoral and uncivilized, a country where vice and irreligion reigned.

Your answers:

70.	71.	72.	73.	74.	75.
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Part 4. For questions 76-85, read the passage and write A, B, C or D in the corresponding numbered boxes provided to indicate the correct answer which fits best according to what is stated or implied.

The Lost Art of Diplomacy

What it can do for you and why society needs to harness its values?

The twentieth century has frequently been labelled as the age of opinion, and not necessarily in a positive way, as any quick glance at social media will demonstrate. In fact, look more closely into the insults traded on social media platforms and the sensationalist ways in which the media presents differing public opinions as polarizing, and the situation starts to look even worse. The modern world can often feel rude, and people often behave as though they are totally unwilling to consider, or even listen to, views that are not aligned with their own. It appears that a change is long overdue, and perhaps diplomacy could be the answer to turning this situation around.

Developed over millennia as a way to mediate between grumpy leaders **hell-bent on** inflicting their own ideas on the world, diplomacy was once thought of as an art, in the same vein as public speaking, polite conversation and negotiation. It grew out of trade interactions in the Middle East, China and India, and incorporated a variety of skills, philosophies and cultural nuances as it went. Throughout the majority of history, the role of the diplomat was to convey information and messages and negotiate in less inflammatory ways than their leaders might have done. These leaders could quite easily justify starting wars in the heat of the moment due to a perceived personal attack from an enemy. In short, they sought to ensure any interaction with another state or power remained **on an even keel** and avoided conflict at all costs.

Although the word 'diplomacy' conjures up a long-gone age of stuffy meetings between politicians and civil servants in palaces and embassies, there is little difference in the goal of diplomacy nowadays. For example, in the complex relationships of modern society, whether in our personal lives, in the workplace or matters of international negotiation, bringing back the art of diplomacy could be invaluable. It is a highly specific skill that requires people to put aside their personal desires and work towards a common good. In this respect it is extremely challenging insofar as it involves putting forward a case for something strongly and effectively enough for it to be considered by another party, but not in such a way as to cause offence or irritation. As the British journalist and writer David Frost once said, "Diplomacy is the art of letting somebody else have your way."

We are inclined to view diplomacy as an innate ability, something that only a select few are blessed with. [A] Yet, with some hard work and determination it is actually straightforward to learn. For people who make a special effort, the benefits will very soon become apparent. [B] There are, as one would expect, certain tricks of the trade that can be useful starting places for novices. [C] This is often the underlying cause of arguments as well as being a plausible explanation for much of the verbal abuse found online today. [D] Being diplomatic means acknowledging the feelings of others, taking time to demonstrate empathy, and casting aside emotion for logic and reasonableness. It means being patient and versatile in interpersonal communication, and, above all, a commitment to agreement and collaboration rather than individuality and division.

Having said this, there are people who seem to naturally excel at diplomatic negotiation and perhaps they are the ones who can shed light on its benefits. These individuals are people who have already understood the human condition in all its frailty. Diplomats are in essence realists who know full well that relationships, families, jobs and nations will face countless problems. They have accepted this with an air of optimistic resignation and believe that compromise is the only antidote to an imperfect world. As such they represent an alternative route to happiness and shared understanding. Despite the outward appearance of pessimism and negativity, they aspire to create a better world and see great progress in small adjustment. They are the undeniable evidence that diplomacy has a lot to offer in illuminating a path to better communication for all of us.

76. *What is the writer's purpose in the first paragraph?*

A. To suggest that the media is manipulating people.

- B. To provide examples of intolerance in modern society.
- C. To outline the problems caused by social media.
- D. To encourage better manners in public places

77. In paragraph 2, what is the writer's opinion of diplomat?

- A. Their influence used to be excessive
- B. They have become less important
- C. Their role is not easy to justify.
- D. They have always been extremely valuable.

78. The phrase **hell-bent on** in paragraph 2 can be best replaced by

- A. skilled in
 - B. biased towards
 - C. insistent on
 - D. adroit at
79. What does the phrase **on an even keel** in paragraph 2 most likely mean?
- A well-thought-out
 - B. well-balanced
 - C. well-intentioned
 - D. fair-minded

80. In paragraph 3, what does the writer imply about diplomacy?

- A. It's beneficial for interpersonal communication:
- B. It's an out-of-date mode of interaction
- C. It's not a worthwhile skill for modern society.
- D. It's an effective technique for political negotiation.

81. In paragraph 4, the writer says that developing our diplomatic skills is _____

- A. easier for more emotional people.
- B. something everyone should aspire to.
- C. too time-consuming for modern life
- D. well worth investing the time and effort

82. In paragraph 5, according to the writer, how do successful diplomats view the world?

- A. They are optimistic about the human condition.
- B. They believe that people should try to overcome suffering
- C. They approach life from a practical perspective
- D. They think that the search for happiness is pointless.

83. In the text, look at the marks (A), (B), (C) and (D) that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage

"The greatest of these is the ability to understand the fragility of human nature and the need for acceptance and for an attentive audience."

Where would this sentence fit be?

- A.
- B.
- C.
- D.

84. What is the main point that the writer wants to make in the article?

- A. A reintroduction of the art of diplomacy would ca tolerance. qual society bond on
- B. Diplomacy is probably the best approach to resolving the fractured mates of society:
- C. Interpersonal skills related to diplomacy could have positive impact on society
- D. While diplomacy has positives, people should he vary of its appropriateness in all contexts.

85. Which of the following can be inferred from the reading passage?

- A. People are gifted with different levels of diplomatic ability at birth.
- B. Leaders will invariably end up in conflict in the absence of diplomats.
- C. Few people can have such a pragmatic approach to life as diplomats.
- D. Diplomats shall play the most crucial role in shaping our future of communication

Your answers:

76.	77.	78.	79.	80.
81.	82.	83.	84.	85.

Part 5. The passage below consists of four sections marked A, B, C and D. For questions 86-95, read the passage and do the task that follows. Write your answers (A, B, C or D) in the corresponding numbered boxes provided.

A Wander through Britain's Woodlands

The president of the Woodland Trust, an organization which encourages people to enjoy the woodlands of Britain, selects his favorite places for an autumn work.

A. Hampstead Heath

Where better for a country walk in autumn than north London? Hampstead Heath is just a few kilometres from the centre

of town, but it is one of the capital's best-known beauty spots. And covering very nearly 325 hectares, certainly one of the largest. It is called a heath, although it is in fact a patchwork of not just heath but also parkland and hedgerow, laid out paths, open hillside and overgrown thickets, lakes and ponds - and plenty of woods and trees. The City of London Corporation is now responsible for its upkeep. They fuss about the swimming, designate cycle paths, regulate the fishing, and put up notices about all such dangerous activities. But despite their best efforts, the Heath still feels quite wild. From one popular vantage point there is a panoramic view of central London, where visitors stop to admire the crowded streets and skyscrapers they have come to the Heath to get away from. It's at its best later in the year. When it's warm and sunny it can feel too crowded with casual visitors. But frosts and mist, rain and snow deter the Heath's fair-weather friends.

B. Hainault Forest

This remnant of what was once the vast Forest of Essex is now an attractive stretch of woodland easily reached by the London Underground. The woods around here were a royal forest, but an Act of Parliament of 1851 authorised the cutting down and removal of its trees. And removed they were, grubbed up by all too efficient men and machines - hectare upon hectare laid waste within weeks of the passing of the Act. The devastation stirred the beginnings of the modern conservation movement - local people led by a politician called Edward North Buxton saved and restored Hainault. It is now owned and managed by the Woodland Trust. Hainault is a unique site, which features open heathland, some of which has been recently planted up with native trees by the Woodland Trust, and the dense woodland of the ancient forest.

C. Glen Finglas

Far away from London and the South East, the Trossachs is Scotland. Among the best of the Trossachs is Glen Finglas, the Woodland Trust's 4,000-hectare estate, which can truly take the breath away, particularly during the late autumn when the frosted peaks and still, cold lochs take on an ethereal splendour. For the enthusiastic hill walker, there is a challenging 25-kilometre trail around the hill called The Mell, which takes you on a meander through woodland, alongside a reservoir and into the upper part of the glen, where the remnants of an ancient royal hunting forest give way to the open hillsides of Meall Cala, reaching a height of 600m. It's certainly not a gentle stroll, but is worth the effort as the views are spectacular. For those after a slightly less arduous journey there are many shorter routes around the site too.

D. Ardkinglas Woodland Gardens

For a slightly different woodland walk in the west of Scotland, head for the Ardkinglas. In addition to native species it features many specimens of firs and pines and other trees from overseas planted in the 19th century, when plant hunting was all the rage. There is plenty of scope for a good walk around its ten hectares. Ardkinglas's sheltered location, high rainfall and warm temperatures all encourage spectacular tree growth, and they claim to have the tallest tree in Britain - a Grand Fir, *Abies grandis* - standing at last time of measuring 64.5 metres high. If you are sceptical of such claims, bring a tape measure and a long ladder. There are many other mighty trees that are impressive all year round but on a clear November day the views towards the loch are fantastic. A couple of miles away on Loch Fyne itself, next to the famous oyster restaurant, Ardkinglas runs a tree shop. So if you want to create your own forest you can buy it and plant it, tree by tree.

Of which place are the following stated?

86. The old and the new intermingles.
87. Its name isn't strictly accurate.
88. This place can take advantage of weather conditions to flourish.
89. Official actions have not changed its fundamental character.
90. It underwent rapid change over a short period.
91. Its cost for preservation is taken charge of by the authority.
92. People who are energetic should love this place.
93. A special occasion is about to highlight the beauty of the lake there.
94. Tourists can reach a destination of beautiful landscapes and lakes through this place.
95. A legislation from a governing body directly threw a wrench into the development of this place.

86.	87.	88.	89.	90.
91.	92.	93.	94.	95.

II. WRITING (5.0 points)

Part 1. Read the following extract and use your own words to summarize it. Your summary should be between 120 and 140 words.

The Dunning-Kruger effect, in psychology, is a cognitive bias whereby people with limited knowledge or competence in a given intellectual or social domain greatly overestimate their own knowledge or competence relative to objective criteria or to the performance of their peers. According to psychologists David Dunning and Justin Kruger, the effect occurs because recognizing deficiencies in one's own knowledge requires a

minimum level of the same knowledge, which those who display the effect lack. Unaware of their deficiencies, such individuals assume they are not deficient, reflecting the general tendency of people to “choose what they think is the most reasonable and optimal option.” Although not scientifically studied until the late 20th century, the phenomenon has long been noted in everyday life and captured in sayings such as “A little knowledge is a dangerous thing” or Darwin’s remark, “Ignorance more frequently begets confidence than does knowledge.” In their influential paper “Unskilled and Unaware of It” (1999), Dunning and Kruger tested young adults in humour, logic, and grammar, and confirmed that incompetent individuals overestimate their abilities, fail to recognize competence, and misjudge performance, though their self-awareness can improve as their competence increases.

Dunning and Kruger also stressed that the effect does not mean people always overestimate their knowledge. Whether they do so depends partly on the domain of evaluation and whether they have reached the “minimal threshold of knowledge, theory, or experience” that triggers false self-belief. For example, most golfers do not imagine they surpass Tiger Woods. The effect also does not rule out the influence of motivational biases and other factors in producing inflated self-assessments among the incompetent. Their research demonstrated that individuals with little skill are doubly disadvantaged: not only do they make mistakes, but their lack of metacognitive ability prevents them from realizing it. Yet, as they acquire competence, they gain the tools to assess themselves more accurately. This paradox highlights the broader psychological insight that ignorance can mask itself, while growth and learning gradually expose the gap between perception and reality. The Dunning-Kruger effect remains a striking reminder that confidence and competence are not always aligned, and that true self-awareness requires both humility and knowledge.

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Education should focus more on teaching students how to think, rather than what to think.
To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Education should focus more on teaching students how to think, rather than what to think.
To what extent do you agree or disagree?

This image shows a full page of a handwriting practice worksheet. It consists of numerous horizontal rows, each defined by two parallel dotted lines. The rows are evenly spaced and extend across the entire width of the page, providing a guide for letter height and placement. There is no text or other markings on the page.

[illegible]

-----THE END-----

